

Jane Street Puzzle June 2026

Andrew Ely

Regional Artwork

frequent Frazier foe
type of magazine you might start getting in your 20's
arguably, the story of our time (and a hint to answering all the *other* clues...)
stage name of a famous skeptic (with "The")
Oscar-winning role from the 80's
often-inset pair, for short
microwaveable snack brand that replaced a refrigerated product
where to find "take thou this vial" and "double, double toil and trouble"
you might break it in Kabul
eponym of multiple continents (and the answer that should come last after sorting)
onetime Outkast output
notable 2026 launch
the present, in the past
our nearest neighbors, in some sense (though we haven't visited yet...)

The answers to these clues need sorting! Move them into their proper locations, then use those moves to populate the final clue, below.

7 8 10 15 12 9 13 6 11 3 14 4 2 5

Understanding The Problem

This month's puzzle does not have very clear instructions. We must do some deciphering and inferring to understand and solve the puzzle. Some first observations we can make is that we have 14 clues, and 14 blank spaces. Some of the clues have additional hints, and there is some context provided for the final solution, suggesting we need to sort the clues.

So, the puzzle seems to consist of answering each clue, then performing some type of sorting. The third clue says it will be a hint to answering all the other clues, so finding an answer for that one should provide more direction.

As a strategy, we can start brainstorming potential answers to each clue by google searching. After coming up with potential answers for each clue, we can look for overlap between the answers we are more confident about and the third clue. Then, we can continue refining our answers to all the other clues by refining our lists based on the hint given by the third clue.

Solving the problem

Initial Searches

Relying on just google searches for now, we can google search each of the clues and record potential answers based on top results and some short exploration, like Wikipedia pages or other top result pages. Doing this, we come up with the following,

clue 1: frequent Frazier foe

potential answers: Ali, Muhammad Ali

clue 2: type of magazine you might start getting in your 20's

potential answers: New York Times, People, academic journals,

clue 3: arguably, the story of our time

potential answers: Robert Atkinson, Christopher Hitchens, "Arguably"

clue 4: stage name of a famous skeptic (with "The")

potential answers: The Amazing Randi, Amazing Randi

clue 5: Oscar-winning role from the 80's

potential answers: Dustin Hoffman, Robert De Niro, Henry Fonda, Ben Kingsley, Robert Duvall, F. Murray Abraham, William Hurt, Paul Newman, Michael Douglas

clue 6: often-inset pair, for short

potential answers: Alaska/Hawaii

clue 7: microwaveable snack brand that replaced a refrigerated product

potential answers: Hotpockets, Micro Magic

clue 8: where to find "take thou this vial" and "double, double toil and trouble"

potential answers: Shakespeare, William Shakespeare

clue 9: you might break it in Kabul

potential answers: Breakfast, Bread, Pul, Afghani

clue 10: eponym of multiple continents

potential answers: Pangaea, Amerigo, Amerigo Vespucci

clue 11: onetime Outkast output

potential answers: In Due Time, Da Art of Storytelling, Aquemini, ATLians

clue 12: notable 2026 launch

potential answers: Artemis II

clue 13: the present, in the past

potential answers: The Future

clue 14: our nearest neighbors, in some sense (though we haven't visited yet...)

potential answers: Mars, Venus, Proxima Centauri, Alpha Centauri

After initial brainstorming, we can realize some answers are much more likely correct than others. We can be confident of some clues like 1, 4, 6, and 12, while clues like 2, 3, 5, and others do not seem to have well fitting answers yet. Taking the most confident answers: Ali (Muhammed Ali), Amazing Randi (The Amazing Randi), Alaska/Hawaii, Artemis II, we can look for a pattern between these answers.

The biggest realization for solving the puzzle is that all of these answers start with the letter “A” and end with the letter “I”. Then, the answer to clue 3 can be AI (Artificial Intelligence), which is definitely fitting as ‘the story of our time’.

Now, with our new constraint that clues must start with the letter “A” and end with letter “I”, we can refine our list of potential answers for clues like 9, 10, 11, and 14. We still need answers for clues 2, 5, 7, 8, and 13.

Also, the instructions at the end of the puzzle tells us the answers need sorting. We also have the additional hint that clue 10’s answer should come last after sorting, which is the clue that is 15 characters long. There are 14 blanks, labeled 2 through 15. If we start with clue 3 being ”AI”, 2 letters long, then each clue’s answer can be a unique length. Making adjustments like this, we result in the following refined search.

Refined Search

Clue	Answer	Num Characters
1	Ali	3
2	???	???
3	AI	2
4	Amazing Randi	12
5	???	???
6	AL,HI	4
7	???	???
8	???	???
9	Afghani	7
10	Amerigo Vespucci	15
11	Aquemini	8
12	Artemis II	9
13	???	???
14	Alpha Centauri	13

So, to follow with our hypothesis, we need words that start with the letter A, end with the letter I, and are 5,6,10,11, and 14 letters long, and fit the remaining clues. Using these constraints, we can solve the more obscure remaining clues:

clue 2: type of magazine you might start getting in your 20’s

answer: Alumni

explanation: An alumni magazine is a type of magazine you can get about your college after you graduate.

clue 5: Oscar-winning role from the 80’s

answer: Antonio Salieri

explanation: The movie “Amadeus” (1984) won 8 awards from the Oscars, including the lead actor F Murry Abraham who played Antonio Salieri, an Italian composer.

clue 7: microwaveable snack brand that replaced a refrigerated product

answer: Act II

explanation: This microwavable popcorn brand replaced the brand Act I, which had to be refrigerated because it contained real butter, while Act II does not.

clue 8: Where to find “take thou this vial” and “double, double toil and trouble”

answer: Act IV, Scene I

explanation: Both of these Shakespeare quotes can be found in Romeo and Juliet, and Macbeth, both in Act four Scene in either play.

clue 13: the present, in the past

answer: Anno Domini

explanation: This is what A.D stands for when using (AD) and (BC) to refer to time periods.

All of these answers fit to give unique lengths of characters between 2 and 15. Now, we have to sort and determine what letter corresponds to each clue. The way to sort that works it to arrange all the answers by length of answer from shortest to longest. Then, we count the number of spaces we had to shift that answer and take the character in the answer at the numbers position. In other words, we take the absolute value of the original clue position (1 to 14) minus its new position, plus one. Then we take the character at that position in the answer, as follows:

Clue	Answer	Num Characters	Shift	Letter
1	Ali	3	1	A
2	Alumni	6	3	U
3	AI	2	2	I
4	Amazing Randi	12	7	G
5	Antonio Salieri	14	8	S
6	AL,HI	4	3	H
7	Act II	5	3	T
8	Act IV, Scene I	11	2	C
9	Afghani	7	3	G
10	Amerigo Vespucci	15	4	R
11	Aquemini	8	4	E
12	Artemis II	9	4	E
13	Anno Domini	10	4	O
14	Alpha Centauri	13	2	L

And populating the final clue by taking the number under the blanks clue number, and that clue numbers corresponding Letter from the table above, we get the final clue:

George Lucas Hit

Following the same constraints as the rest of the puzzle, and as hinted at by the title of the puzzle “Regional Artwork”, the final answer is:

American Graffiti